

SCULPTURE, POTTERY AND ICONOGRAPHY

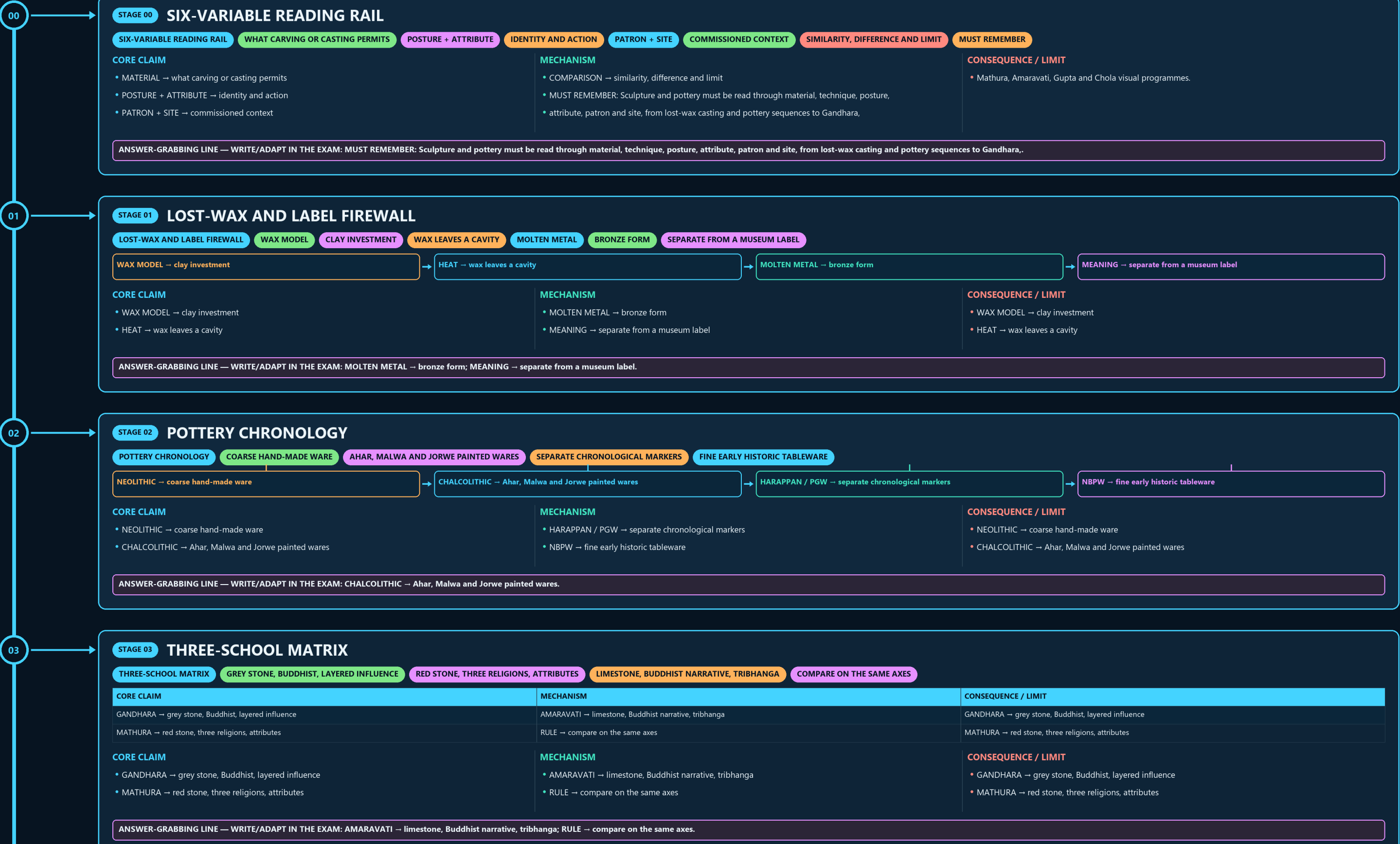
SIX-VARIABLE READING RAIL → LOST-WAX AND LABEL FIREWALL → POTTERY CHRONOLOGY → THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX → ANICONIC TO ICONIC → GUPTA BRIDGE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CHALCOLITHIC — Ahar, Malwa and Jorwe painted wares.

03

STAGE 03 THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX

THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX

GREY STONE, BUDDHIST, LAYERED INFLUENCE

RED STONE, THREE RELIGIONS, ATTRIBUTES

LIMESTONE, BUDDHIST NARRATIVE, TRIBHANGA

COMPARE ON THE SAME AXES

CORE CLAIM

GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence

MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

CORE CLAIM

• GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence

• MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

MECHANISM

AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga

RULE → compare on the same axes

MECHANISM

• AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga

• RULE → compare on the same axes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence

MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence

• MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga; RULE → compare on the same axes.

04

STAGE 04 ANICONIC TO ICONIC

ANICONIC TO ICONIC

EMPTY THRONE

SYMBOLIC PRESENCE

DEVOTIONAL CHANGE

HUMAN IMAGE BECOMES CENTRAL

GANDHARA + MATHURA

OVERLAPPING EARLY-CE CONTEXTS

NO UNCONTESTED SOLE ORIGIN

EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence

DEVOTIONAL CHANGE → human image becomes central

GANDHARA + MATHURA → overlapping early-CE contexts

CAUTION → no uncontested sole origin

CORE CLAIM

• EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence

• DEVOTIONAL CHANGE → human image becomes central

MECHANISM

• GANDHARA + MATHURA → overlapping early-CE contexts

• CAUTION → no uncontested sole origin

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence

• DEVOTIONAL CHANGE → human image becomes central

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence.

05

STAGE 05 GUPTA BRIDGE

GUPTA BRIDGE

CREAM SANDSTONE

SUBTLE MODELLING AND THIN DRAPERY

LATE OR POST-GUPTA CAUTION

RESTRAINT BEFORE DENSER TEMPLE PROGRAMMES

CORE CLAIM

SARNATH → cream sandstone

BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery

CORE CLAIM

• SARNATH → cream sandstone

• BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery

MECHANISM

SULTANGANJ → late or post-Gupta caution

BRIDGE → restraint before denser temple programmes

MECHANISM

• SULTANGANJ → late or post-Gupta caution

• BRIDGE → restraint before denser temple programmes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

SARNATH → cream sandstone

BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• SARNATH → cream sandstone

• BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SULTANGANJ → late or post-Gupta caution; BRIDGE → restraint before denser temple programmes.

06

STAGE 06 NATARAJA CHRONOLOGY

NATARAJA CHRONOLOGY

EARLY KNOWN ANTECEDENT

CANONICAL PORTABLE BRONZE

TEMPLE PROCESSION

RITUAL MOBILITY

PEAK IS NOT ORIGIN

AIHOLE → early known antecedent

CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility

RULE → peak is not origin

CORE CLAIM

• AIHOLE → early known antecedent

• CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

MECHANISM

• TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility

• RULE → peak is not origin

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• AIHOLE → early known antecedent

• CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility; RULE → peak is not origin.

07

STAGE 07 NATARAJA ATTRIBUTE MAP

06

STAGE 06

## NATARAJA CHRONOLOGY

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EARLY KNOWN ANTECEDENT

CANONICAL PORTABLE BRONZE

TEMPLE PROCESSION

RITUAL MOBILITY

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### CORE CLAIM

- AIHOLE → early known antecedent
- CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

### MECHANISM

- TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility
- RULE → peak is not origin

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- AIHOLE → early known antecedent
- CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility; RULE → peak is not origin.

07

STAGE 07

## NATARAJA ATTRIBUTE MAP

NATARAJA ATTRIBUTE MAP

CREATION AND DESTRUCTION

RAISED FOOT

REASSURANCE AND RELEASE

IGNORANCE SUBDUED

RECURRING TIME

DAMARU / FIRE → creation and destruction

ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release

APASMARA → ignorance subdued

AUREOLE → recurring time

### CORE CLAIM

- DAMARU / FIRE → creation and destruction
- ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release

### MECHANISM

- APASMARA → ignorance subdued
- AUREOLE → recurring time

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DAMARU / FIRE → creation and destruction
- ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release.

08

STAGE 08

## LION-BULL EVIDENCE LADDER

LION-BULL EVIDENCE LADDER

BULL VISIBLE, MEANING UNRECOVERABLE

INSCRIBED LION, UNINSCRIBED BULL

ANIMALS INSIDE A BUDDHIST-IMPERIAL SYSTEM

NANDI, YALI AND VYALA GAIN PLACED ROLES

### CORE CLAIM

- HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable
- RAMPURVA → inscribed lion, uninscribed bull

### MECHANISM

- SARNATH → animals inside a Buddhist-imperial system
- TEMPLE → Nandi, Yali and Vyala gain placed roles

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE → Nandi, Yali and Vyala gain placed roles.

09

STAGE 09

## TEMPLE ANIMAL PLACEMENT

TEMPLE ANIMAL PLACEMENT

AXIAL PAVILION BEFORE SHIVA

COMPOSITE GUARDIAN ON SOUTHERN PILLARS

LION-BODIED HYBRID AT KHAJURAHO

BUILDING, GUARDIAN AND MOTIF

CLOSE DISTINCTION

GANDHARA, MATHURA AND AMARAVATI DIFFER BY MATERIAL, RELIGIOUS SCOPE

### CORE CLAIM

- NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva
- YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars

### MECHANISM

- VYALA → lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho
- DISTINCTION → building, guardian and motif

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati differ by material, religious scope and visual grammar
- symbolic Buddha representation preceded broadly overlapping Gandhara-Mathura iconic production, so sole-origin claims are unsafe.

### CORE CLAIM

- NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva
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STAGE 09 TEMPLE ANIMAL PLACEMENT

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MECHANISM

VYALA → lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho  
DISTINCTION → building, guardian and motif

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

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10

STAGE 10 SOCIAL-EVIDENCE TEST

SOCIAL-EVIDENCE TEST

DANCER, MUSICIAN, TEACHER OR COUPLE

SELECTED WHAT BECAME VISIBLE

VALUED ACTIVITY OR RITUAL IDIOM

NOT A CENSUS OF SOCIETY

EVIDENCE LIMIT

PASHUPATI, MOTHER GODDESS AND PRIEST-KING ARE MODERN HARAPPAN LABELS

FIGURE → dancer, musician, teacher or couple

PATRON → selected what became visible

CLAIM → valued activity or ritual idiom

LIMIT → not a census of society

CORE CLAIM

- FIGURE → dancer, musician, teacher or couple
- PATRON → selected what became visible

MECHANISM

- CLAIM → valued activity or ritual idiom
- LIMIT → not a census of society

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern Harappan labels
- Chola bronzes canonised rather than originated Nataraja, and temple sculpture records patron-selected visibility rather than a social census.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern Harappan labels; Chola bronzes canonised rather than originated Nataraja, and temple sculpture records patron-selected visibility rather than a social census.

11

STAGE 11 SCULPTURE ANSWER SPINE

SCULPTURE ANSWER SPINE

SCHOOL, OBJECT OR SYMBOL

MATERIAL, POSTURE, ATTRIBUTE AND SITE

PERIOD OR REGIONAL WORKSHOP

ATTRIBUTION, PRIORITY AND SOCIAL INFERENCE

DEFINE → school, object or symbol

EVIDENCE → material, posture, attribute and site

COMPARE → period or regional workshop

QUALIFY → attribution, priority and social inference

CORE CLAIM

- DEFINE → school, object or symbol
- EVIDENCE → material, posture, attribute and site

MECHANISM

- COMPARE → period or regional workshop
- QUALIFY → attribution, priority and social inference

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DEFINE → school, object or symbol
- EVIDENCE → material, posture, attribute and site

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPARE → period or regional workshop; QUALIFY → attribution, priority and social inference.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

NO URGENT CURRENT-STATUS CORRECTION IS REQUIRED FOR THIS TOPIC'S

TREATING CHOLA PATRONAGE AS THE ORIGIN OF NATARAJA ICONOGRAPHY.

TREATING "INDO-GREEK" (GANDHARA) AS MEANING THE SCULPTURE IS

ASSUMING ICONOGRAPHIC ATTRIBUTE IDENTIFICATION ALWAYS OVER-RIDES

TREATING TRADITIONAL MUSEUM LABELS AS DECODED HARAPPAN IDENTITIES.

ASSIGNING DIDARGANJ AUTOMATICALLY TO THE MAURYAS. - ITS POLISH

TOPIC 13 OWNS THE DOCTRINAL/THEOLOGICAL SIGNIFICANCE OF

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- No urgent current-status correction is required for this topic's
- NOT: Treating Chola patronage as the origin of Nataraja iconography. - The
- NOT: Treating "Indo-Greek" (Gandhara) as meaning the sculpture is
- NOT: Assuming iconographic attribute identification always over-rides

ADVANCED DEBATE

- NOT: Treating traditional museum labels as decoded Harappan identities.
- NOT: Assigning Didarganj automatically to the Mauryas. - Its polish supports
- NOT: Topic 13 owns the doctrinal/theological significance of
- NOT: Ancient/Medieval History owns the political chronology of the

LEGACY / NUANCE

- This file's six-factor method is directly reusable for topic 03's
- Foundation companion: basic/06 Sculpture-Pottery-and-Iconography.md.
- 00 Master-Framework.md Section 2 — the "how to read a monument,
- CAUTION: Cross-links: Topic 03 (Chandella sculptural-programme dossier,

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.